MIL-T-36815D
16 September 1977
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22 April 1976 and
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8 July 1975

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

TUBE, BIOLOGICAL CULTURE SAMPLING, WITH TRANSPORT MEDIA

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers a biological culture sampling tube suitable for collecting and holding biological cultures moist for 72 hours.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Issues of documents. The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

PPP-B-566 - Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-676 - Box, Setup.

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Headquarters, Defense Personnel Support Center, ATTN: Directorate of Medical Materiel, DPSC-ATT, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, PA 19101, by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

FSC 6640

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(Copies of specifications, standards, and publications required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals shall apply.

U. S. DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH, EDUCATION, AND WELFARE

FOOD AND DRUG ADMINISTRATION

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act and Code of Federal Regulations, Title, 21, Chapter I.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

U. S. PHARMACOPEIAL CONVENTION, INC.

Pharmacopeia of the United States of America

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Mack Publishing Company, Easton, PA 18042.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. Material shall be as hereinafter specified. If material is not specified it shall be suitable for its intended function.

3.2 Construction. Culture sample unit shall consist of a tube equipped with closure, applicator swab and transport medium chamber. The entire unit shall be enclosed in an envelope-type covering suitable for maintaining sterility.

3.2.1 Tube. The tube shall be fabricated of transparent or translucent semi-rigid plastic tubing. One end shall be sealed to preclude leakage when tested as specified in 4.4.1. The open end shall have a snug-fitting, easily removable, plastic closure. Internal area and design shall be such that it does not impede the removal and replacement of the applicator swab (see 3.2.1.1).

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3.2.1.1 Applicator. The applicator swab shall be semi-rigid, cylindrical plastic stick covered at one end with non-woven rayon or polyester swab tip. The non-woven fabric shall be tightly wound to form a pear-shaped tip which shall extend at least 1/16 inch beyond the end of the stick. Adhesion of the tip to the stick shall be accomplished by partial solution with a suitable volatile solvent. Uncovered end of stick shall be affixed to the cap. Stick shall be flexible and shall not break when tested in accordance with 4.4.2.

3.2.1.2 Separator plug. When a glass ampul is used to contain the transport media (see 3.2.1.3) a plug of absorbent non-woven fabric (see 3.1.2) shall be placed in the tube to separate the applicator swab tip from the media ampul at the bottom of the tube. The weight of the plug shall be not less than 50 milligrams (mg). The plug shall absorb the media which is released when the ampul is crushed. The media-saturated plug shall provide media to the swab tip.

3.2.1.3 Transport media and media chamber. Media shall not contain charcoal. Media shall be a water-like liquid or a viscous liquid which contains agar. If water-like liquid is furnished, it shall be Modified Stuarts Transport Media, 0.5 ± 0.1 milliliters (ml) shall be furnished in an onionskin glass ampul. The filled ampul shall be sterilized in an autoclave for 30 minutes at 15 pounds per square inch (psi) Stuarts media shall have a pH of 7.5 + .4 - .3. If a viscous liquid is furnished, it shall be Amies Transport Media; 0.7 ± 0.2 ml shall be placed in the bottom of the tube. Tube shall be sealed above the transport media to form a media chamber and to keep applicator tip from the media until the seal is pressed or squeezed. Size of media chamber shall be such that the specified amount of media is sufficient to cover the applicator tip when instructions are followed (see 3.9.e). Amies media shall have a pH of 7.2 ± .2.

3.3 Dimensions. Dimensions shall be as shown in table I.

TABLE I. Dimensions in inches.

Diameter of applicator stick	.095 + .010
Length of applicator (stick plus tip)	6 + 1/4
Overall length (tube plus closure)	7-3/4 ± 1/2

3.4 Envelope. An envelope or other suitable container shall completely enclose the assembled culture tube. The envelope shall be adequately sealed and shall maintain sterility of the tube and contents until manually opened (see 4.4.3). Closure or flap of envelope shall be so constructed as to afford easy access to the enclosed culture tube.

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3.5 Sterility. Culture tube and components contained therein and transport media shall be sterile when tested as specified in 4.4.3.

3.5.1 Certificate of sterility. A certificate of sterility, stating that sample from each sterilizer charge has been tested and found to be sterile, shall be submitted to the procuring activity. The certificate of sterility shall include:

a. Item Identification.
b. National Stock Number (NSN).
c. Contract or purchase order number.
d. Sterility lot or control number.
e. Date of sterilization.
f. Method of sterilization.
g. The biological indicator used with test samples.
h. Date sterility test was started.
i. Specific test results.
j. Statement that samples comply (or do not comply) with sterility tests.
k. Signature of head of laboratory or a designated qualified alternate.
l. Quantity in sterilizer load.

When inspection is made at destination, the certificate of sterility shall be submitted by the contractor to the Directorate of Medical Materiel, ATTN: DPSC-ATQ, Defense Personnel Support Center, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, PA 19101, and a copy forwarded with each shipment to the consignee. When inspection is made at source, certificate of sterility shall be furnished to the cognizant Government Quality Assurance Representative for submission to the procuring activity.

3.5.2 Lot size. A sterility lot size shall consist of a manufacturer's lot subjected to the same sterilizer load. Each unit package shall be clearly marked with a lot number as specified in 5.3.2, which shall be traceable to the pertinent manufacturing batch and date of sterilization.

3.6 Viability and toxicity. When tested as specified in 4.4.4, microbial viability shall be sustained in sample tubes for 72 hours; growth in sample tubes shall be equal or better than growth in control tubes.

3.7 Date of delivery. Date of delivery shall be not more than 60 days after the date of manufacture unless tube with glass ampul is supplied. When tube with glass ampule is supplied, media may be manufactured 75 days before date of delivery.

3.8 Expiration date. The expiration date shall be not less than 18 months from the date of manufacture. At any time before the expiration date, culture tube shall comply with requirements in 3.6.

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3.9 Marking on envelope. Envelope containing culture sampling tube shall be legibly marked with the following information:

a. Item Identification.
b. Contractor's name and address.
c. "Sterile."
d. Lot number.
e. Directions for use.

3.10 Workmanship. Workmanship shall be first class throughout. Biological culture sampling tube shall be free of defects listed in table IV and other defects which may impair their serviceability.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of 3 years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

4.1.2 Inspection. Inspection, as used in this specification, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

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4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 For examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and table II. Sample unit shall be one culture sampling tube. No more than two culture tubes shall be taken from any one unit package.

TABLE II. For examination.

	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective)
For visual examination		
Major defects	S-4	1.0
Minor defects	S-4	4.0
For dimensional examination	S-1	2.5

4.2.2 For tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and table III. Acceptance number shall be zero.

TABLE III. For tests.

Component (unit of product)	Characteristic	Requirement	Test procedure	Inspection level
Tube only	Leakage	3.2.1	4.4.1	S-3
Applicator swab	Flexibility	3.2.1.1	4.4.2	S-2
Culture sampling tube	Sterility	3.5	4.4.3	S-3
	Viability and toxicity	3.6	4.4.4	4.4.4

4.3 Examination. The tube shall be examined to determine compliance with all requirements contained in this specification. Examination shall be in accordance with defects listed in table IV.

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TABLE IV. Classification of defects.

Category	Defect
Major	
101	Component missing.
102	Envelope not free of tears and holes.
103	Envelope not sealed.
104	Closure not held securely in place.
105	Closure and tube not free of cracks and tears.
106	Applicator sticks not free of cracks and breaks.
107	Marking on envelope not complete, correct and legible.
108	Applicator swab not separated from ampul and media (as applicable).
109	Media chamber seal does not separate or ampul is not readily crushable when outside of tube is squeezed between the thumb and forefinger.
110	Culture tube not easily removed from the envelope.
Minor	
201	Applicator tip not free of loose fibers. (Moisten applicator tip, rub tip on back of hand for at least 5 seconds and check for fibers on the back of hand.)
202	Applicator stick not free of kinks or bends.
203	Applicator tip not secured to stick.
204	Applicator tip not pear-shaped.
205	Closure and tube not free of sharp edges and protrusions which destroy package integrity or which may induce injury to the patient.
206	Applicator tip not free of dirt or foreign matter.
207	Tube not free of functional deformation.

4.3.1 Dimensional examination. The tubes and components (applicator tips) shall be examined for defects in dimensions. Any dimension not within the tolerance specified herein shall be classified as a defect.

4.3.2 Packaging inspection. The inspection of the unit, intermediate package, packing and marking for shipment and storage shall be in accordance with quality assurance provisions of the applicable container specification and the marking requirements of MIL-STD-129.

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4.4 Tests.

4.4.1 Leakage test. For tubes where media chamber is formed by a top and bottom seal, top seal shall be tested as follows: Remove the closure and applicator swab. Fill the tube to the top with indicator (water containing a suitable dye). Allow the tubes to stand upright for at least two hours. Indicator inside of media chamber shall be evidence of leakage through the top seal. For all tubes the bottom seal shall be tested by adding 3 - 4 ml of indicator (water containing a suitable dye) to an empty tube. Allow the tubes to stand upright for at least two hours. Bottom of tubes shall be examined for wetness and the paper shall be observed for color spots and wetness. For tubes which contain a glass media chamber, an empty tube shall be produced by removing all components from the tube. For tubes which contain a media chamber formed by a top and bottom seal an empty tube shall be produced by removing the closure and applicator swab and separating the top seal in accordance with instructions (see 3.9) and removing all the media. If necessary for complete removal of media, the inside of the tube shall be rinsed with water.

4.4.2 Flexibility test. Grasped at both ends, the sample swabs shall be bent at an angle of at least 80° at a point approximately midway.

4.4.3 Sterility. Culture sampling units (tube, components and media) shall be tested for sterility in accordance with method specified in the USP Procedural Details for Sterility Tests for Class B, Type II, Inoculated Products or Inoculated Carrier for Non-Parenteral Devices.

4.4.4 Viability and toxicity.

a. Cultures.
Prepare bacterial suspensions (10,000/ml) in physiological saline from 18-24 hour broth cultures of the following micro-organisms:

1. Group a Streptococcus ATCC No. 7958
2. Pseudomonas aeruginosa ATCC No. 15442

b. Controls
Controls shall be a simulation of the biological culture sampling tube, and shall consist of the following equivalent components:

Glass tube
Stainless steel applicator stick
Applicator swab tip of USP cotton secured to stick without use of adhesive.
Closure - Metal or similar as in culture tube

Control tubes shall be sterilized in an autoclave for 30 minutes at 121° Centigrade (°C) and 15 psi.

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c. Procedure

1. Inoculate at least 10 sample tubes by dipping the tip (swab) in the bacterial suspensions from each of the cultures of a.1 and a.2. Proceed in accordance with directions on sample envelope. Leave culture in tube for 72 hours at room temperature (20° - 30°C). During this 72 hours the tube shall be in a vertical position. In order to duplicate the condition of lowest moisture availability, the media chamber shall be at the bottom in the tubes which contain glass media chambers and the media chamber shall be at the top in tubes which have media chambers with top and bottom seals.

2. Dip tip (swab) on one control applicator stick in bacterial suspension of a.1 and one in bacterial suspension of a.2 and place in glass control tubes. Add 0.5 ml + .1 ml of Modified Stuart's Transport Meida, pH 7.5 + .4, -.3, or .7 + .2 ml Amies Transport Media pH 7.2 + 2 as applicable (see 3.2.1.3) to each of the control tubes.

3. Incubate cultures a.1 and a.2 at 36°C + 1° for 72 hours.

4. Remove cultures from incubator and add 2.5 ml of sterile double trypticase soy broth (see 6.1) into each culture tube.

5. Reincubate cultures for 2 hours at 36°C + 1°.

6. Remove cultures from the incubator and inoculate a trypticase soy blood agar plate (see 6.1) with material from each sample and control.

NOTE: Remove cultures from the incubator and inoculate a trypticase soy blood agar plate (see 6.1) with material from each tube. Seeding with applicator swab shall be accomplished in the same manner throughout the plating procedure, using approximately the same amount of inoculum.

7. Incubate plate cultures at 36°C + 1° for 18-24 hours.

8. Remove plate cultures from the incubator and compare the growth in sample plates and control plates.

5. PACKAGING.

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be Level A or C as specified (see 6.3).

5.1.1 Unit of issue. One package containing 100 tubes, as specified constitutes one unit of issue.

5.1.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1.1 Individual container. Each assembled sterile culture tube shall be packaged in a sealed peel-open type envelope of appropriate size and design capable of maintaining sterility of contents unless damaged or opened. The envelope shall be constructed of paper or plastic or a combination of paper and plastic.

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5.1.1.1.2 Unit package. Each unit of issue, 100 tubes, shall be packaged in a box of appropriate size constructed in accordance with PPP-B-566, PPP-B-676 or PPP-B-636, type CF, class domestic. Closure shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification.

5.1.1.2 Level C. Units shall be packaged in standard commercial containers of the size and kind commonly used, which will afford the degree of protection required for shipment and use of the product for its intended purpose.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be Level A, B or C as specified (see 6.3).

5.2.1 Level A. Twelve unit packages shall be packed in an exterior container designed for a type 2 load and conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. Closure, waterproofing and strapping shall be as specified in the appendix of the box specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Twelve unit packages shall be packed in an exterior container designed for a type 2 load and conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. Closure shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. The subject commodity shall be packed in substantial commercial containers of the type, size and kind commonly used for the purpose, so constructed as to insure acceptance and safe delivery by common or other carriers, at the lowest rate, to point of delivery called for in the contract or purchase order.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Individual container. Each individual container shall be marked with item name, name and address of manufacturer, lot (control) number, expiration date, requirements of Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, instructions for use, and the legends, "STERILE" and "STERILITY GUARANTEED UNLESS PACKAGE IS DAMAGED OR OPENED" or similar statement.

5.3.2 Unit package. Each unit package shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. Lot (control) number, contract or purchase order number and name and address of the contractor shall be shown. Type II shelf life markings as specified in MIL-STD-129 shall be shown, except that expiration date shall be shown in lieu of date of manufacture. The inspection test date shall be left blank. The method of sterilization (G-Gas, R-Radiation, S-Steam, D-Dry heat sterilization) shall be shown following the level and the date of packaging. Example: "A-1/75-G." Final sterilization shall be on or after indicated packaging date. Marking shall also include the legend: "STORE AT CONTROLLED ROOM TEMPERATURE 15^{0} - 30^{0} C (59^{0} - 86^{0} F)".

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5.3.3 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. Lot (control) number and the method of sterilization as specified in 5.3.2 shall be shown. Type II shelf life markings as specified in MIL-STD-129 shall be shown, except that expiration date shall be shown in lieu of date of manufacture. The inspection test date shall be left blank. Marking shall include the legend: "STORE AT CONTROLLED ROOM TEMPERATURE 15^{0} - 30^{0} C (59^{0} - 86^{0} F)".

6. NOTES

6.1 Trypticase soy blood agar plates and trypticase soy broth may be obtained from Baltimore Biological Laboratories as BBL 168 and BBL 162 respectively.

6.2 ATCC No. 7958 and ATCC No. 15442 may be obtained from American Type Culture Collection, 12301 Parklawn, Rockville, MD 20852.

6.3 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

a. Title, number and date of this specification.
b. National Stock Number (NSN).
c. Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).

6.4 National Stock Number (NSN) Coverage. This specification covers the following item listed in the Federal Supply Catalog:

National Stock No.	Item Identification
6640-00-518-5462	TUBE, BIOLOGICAL CULTURE SAMPLING, WITH TRANSPORT MEDIA, PLASTIC, 100s

¢.% Asterisks are nto used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue, due to the extensiveness of the changes.

Custodians:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Review activity:
DOD - MB

Preparing activity:
(DLA-DM)

Project No. 6640-0999

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MIL-T-36815D TUBE, BIOLOGICAL CULTURE SAMPLING, WITH TRANSPORT MEDIA

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